Instructor Guide: The OrbitCo 5-Minute Capstone Briefing

Type: Individual exercise (small-group delivery) **Time:** 30 minutes (5 min plan + 15 min build + 5 min rehearse + 5 min per learner in small groups to deliver)

Pre-Activity Setup

- Confirm every learner has access to the Lesson 1 workbook (their own cleaned `Tickets` / `Uptime` / `SLALookup` Tables + the `outputs` KPI summary) and the Lesson 2 dashboard file. If any learner is missing one of these, pair them with a classmate for the build phase — the capstone is integration, and a learner building from scratch cannot finish in the time budget.
- Project the four-dimension rubric (data handling, visualization, presentation, communication) on the wall for the full 30 minutes. Learners will self-check against it; visible rubric is the load-bearing facilitation device here.
- Divide the class in half at launch: one half prepares the executive version, the other half the technical-peer version. Assign by simple count-off or by prior experience (learners who rarely present to executives get the executive version; learners who rarely present to technical peers get the technical one). The assignment sticks for the entire capstone.
- Pre-arrange small groups of three or four for the delivery phase. Each group needs at least one executive-version presenter and one technical-version presenter so learners see both patterns.
- Have a visible countdown timer for every phase (plan, build, rehearse, deliver). The five-minute delivery constraint is part of the skill being evaluated; a timer in the room makes the constraint real.

Facilitation Steps

1. **0:00 — Launch** (2 min): Walk through the rubric briefly. Announce executive-vs-technical assignments. Remind learners that the data is identical across both versions — only the lead and depth change. Start the plan timer.

2. **0:02 — Plan phase** (5 min): Circulate. Watch for learners jumping straight into PowerPoint before writing the arc. Stop them: "Put the PowerPoint away. Arc on paper first." Also watch for learners writing a recommendation that is hedged ("we should probably consider...") — a hedged recommendation is not a recommendation. Push for "I recommend X" or "The right call is X."

3. **0:07 — Build phase** (15 min): This is the longest window and the most valuable circulation time. Rotate through all learners at least twice. Key things to catch:

   - **Not using the Slide Master.** If a learner is formatting per-slide, intervene. Open the master on their laptop, set the title font, close the master, and show them the difference.
   - **Linked paste from Excel.** The deck will be delivered on their own laptop so linked paste might look fine in build — but the capstone's delivery scenario (a simulated audience of four) is the early rehearsal for a "send this to someone who does not have the Excel" situation. Push for Paste Special → Picture. It is the habit that matters.
   - **No chart annotations.** Every chart needs a sentence title, a callout, and a takeaway label. Learners default to pasting Excel's default chart. Push for the transformation — the demo from the lesson is the reference pattern.
   - **Executive version with methodology slides.** A common slip: the executive build still includes a "how we analyzed the data" slide. Cut it. The exec version does not methodology.

4. **0:22 — Rehearse phase** (5 min): Every learner should run Rehearse Timings at least twice. Circulate and watch for learners who skip rehearsal and "just plan to run through it in their head" — that is the single most common timing failure in the delivery phase. Push them to actually run the slideshow.

5. **0:27 — Deliver phase** (in groups of 3-4, 5 min per learner, ~15-20 min total depending on group size): Time each delivery visibly. Do not cut a learner off on their first attempt, but name timing in the feedback round. After each delivery, the group asks one question from the presenter's anticipated-five. The presenter either answers from appendix or says "I do not know, I will follow up."

6. **End — Brief close** (included in the final peer-feedback activity): Name the three most common failure modes you saw (no explicit recommendation, chart-narration rather than chart-takeaway, over time). Preview the peer-feedback round as the immediate next activity.

What to Circulate For

- **No explicit recommendation.** The deck builds toward a conclusion but the speaker never states it in a single sentence. Ask the learner: "Read me the recommendation sentence." If they cannot, their audience will not hear one either. Force the revision before delivery.
- **Talking about the data rather than the decision.** Learners narrate what each chart shows ("here is the weekly trend; it goes up then down then up again") without connecting to the recommendation. Prompt: "So what? What does this chart mean for the decision on the table?"
- **Too many slides for the time budget.** Nine slides in five minutes is impossible to deliver well. If a learner has more than seven slides, force a cut during the build phase — much harder to cut during rehearsal and impossible during delivery.
- **Linked paste instead of picture paste.** Worth catching in build. If the deck is delivered on the learner's own laptop the link will work, but the instruction is picture — and the reason ("the audience does not have your Excel") is the teachable moment.
- **Speaker notes empty or bullet-fragmented.** Empty speaker notes mean the presenter will ad-lib, which always eats time. Bullet-fragments mean they will ad-lib at higher resolution but still ad-lib. Push for full sentences — at minimum the first sentence of each slide's delivery.
- **Appendix missing or unindexed.** An appendix without an index is unusable under Q&A pressure. If a learner built an appendix but did not add the one-line index on the last visible slide, add it during circulation.

Common Pitfalls

- **"I have all the data, I will just talk through it."** The no-deck approach is not faster; it is slower and less credible. If a learner is avoiding the build phase, name

it: "Talking through data is a data dump. The deck is the structure that keeps you honest." Redirect to the arc on paper.

- **Recommendation is an option, not a decision.** "We could refactor runbooks, or hire, or tighten paging" is not a recommendation — it is the options slide. Push for commitment: "Which one? State it."
- **Rehearse Timings run on a laptop with the clicker disconnected.** The timing is close to accurate but the actual delivery changes when the presenter has to click through. If possible, have learners rehearse with the same clicker or remote they will deliver with.
- **Presenter View on a single-monitor laptop.** PowerPoint may default to "Presenter View on monitor 1, slideshow on monitor 2" on a dual-monitor setup, but on single-monitor delivery the learner might see only the slideshow. Show the Display Settings → Swap Presenter View and Slideshow dropdown under Slide Show tab, or the workaround of using Presenter View on a second laptop/phone.
- **Feedback comes out generic.** "Your deck was nice" is useless. The peer-feedback activity that follows this capstone is where specific feedback gets trained; model it yourself during the delivery round so the feedback round has the bar already set.

Debrief Prompts

- **"What did you cut from your deck between build and rehearsal, and why?"** Expected answer: one or two slides, usually because the timing rehearsal showed the deck running over five minutes. The cut is the skill. Name it: "The cut is the hardest thing about a capstone like this — and it is the most valuable part of the build."
- **"What was the hardest question you got from your group? How did you handle it?"** Draws out either the appendix use (if the learner was prepared) or the 'I do not know, I will follow up' pattern (if they were not). Both are successful outcomes; flag the paper-over instinct if anyone tried it.
- **"If you had to deliver this briefing again next month with fresh 30-day data, what would you change about the deck structure to make it reusable?"** Leads to the OJL 5d point explicitly: the capstone deck is operational documentation. Linked charts become viable if the audience has the Excel; master layouts become

more valuable; the appendix grows. Name this as the on-the-job outcome — a briefing that gets reused over months is a stronger artifact than one delivered once and discarded.

Expected Answers

A reference-grade capstone briefing meets these criteria on the four-dimension rubric:

Dimension	Meets bar (reference)
Data handling	All numbers cited in the deck trace back to the Lesson 1 `Tickets` Table or `outputs` KPI summary. Formulas use structured references. No hardcoded ranges surface in the appendix screenshots.
Visualization	Every chart is a picture-paste with a sentence title, one callout, and a plain-language takeaway. No 3D, no truncated axes, no default Excel palette unchanged. The dashboard layout (tiles → trends → details) from Lesson 2 carries across.
Presentation	Deck follows problem → evidence → options → recommendation (forward or inverted per version). One idea per slide. Slide Master enforces typography and palette. Five to seven visible slides; appendix indexed on the last visible slide.
Communication	Recommendation stated in one sentence at the right point in the deck (slide 2 exec, slide 6 technical). Speaker notes full sentences. Delivered within five minutes. At least three of the five anticipated questions answered from appendix or prepared notes; any unanswered questions handled with "I do not know, I will follow up."

If a learner's briefing misses one rubric row but hits the other three, the briefing is "Meets" overall. Capstone passes at Meets or better. Learners who hit Exceeds on all four are given their own deck as a template for future use — the course's final OJL 5d outcome.